EXPERIMENT 09

Creating Custom Dashboards, Reports, and Analytics in Zoho Creator

Library Book Issue Request Form (Reporting & Analytics Use Case)

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1. Aim

To design and configure custom reports, graphical charts, pivot tables, and analytical dashboards within a Zoho Creator application (Library Book Issue Request Form) to provide real-time operational insights for administrators and library staff.

The experiment covers list reports, summary reports, chart components (bar, pie, line), filter criteria, drill-down capabilities, and dashboard layout design.

2. Procedure

Step 1: Identify reporting requirements. Determined key performance indicators (KPIs) needed for library management, including total active book requests, overdue fines collected, popular book categories, and monthly issue trends.

Step 2: Create tabular and list reports. Configured searchable list views with customized column sets, sorting rules, and quick search filters for student and book records.

Step 3: Build summary and pivot reports. Grouped transaction data by book genre and issue status to calculate aggregate metrics such as total fines and issue counts.

Step 4: Design graphical chart components. Created bar charts for monthly book requests and pie charts for fine distribution across departments.

Step 5: Assemble the executive dashboard. Combined KPI cards, charts, and list reports onto a centralized dashboard page tailored for librarian and administrator oversight.

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Note: This is a structured reporting exercise. Dashboard metrics and chart layouts follow standard Zoho Creator analytics design principles.

3. Output

3.1 Dashboard Components & KPI Metrics

The analytics dashboard summarizes key operational data across multiple visualization panels:

Component Type	Data Source	Visualization Format	Purpose
KPI Card	Book Issue Form	Numeric Counter	Display total pending and approved book requests.
Monthly Trend	Transaction Logs	Line Chart	Track book borrowing volume across academic montl
Genre Breakdown	Book Catalog	Pie Chart	Analyze popularity distribution across literary genres.
Fine Summary	Fine Records Table	Summary / Pivot Table	Monitor collected vs. pending overdue fines.

3.2 Report Filtering and Drill-Down Configuration

Interactive filters were implemented on list and summary reports, allowing administrators to filter records dynamically by date range, department, and student roll number. Clicking on any chart segment instantly drills down to the underlying transaction records.

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3.3 Role-Based Dashboard Access

Dashboard views were restricted based on user profiles: students can view their personal borrowing history and active requests, while librarians and administrators have full visibility over system-wide analytics, inventory turnover, and fine summaries.

4. Final Result

Successfully designed and configured custom reports, graphical charts, and analytical dashboards for the Library Book Issue Request Form application in Zoho Creator, providing robust operational visibility and decision-support tools.

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